



MOBILE MADNESS

You have to try these games out on your smartphone!

Team Digit

Time Defenders

As Time Defenders introduces you to its highly anime-like, steadily paced tale, this tower defence anime game has a range of characters.

Comparatively speaking, it is a more specialised genre than the generic RPGs. The 30 chances to cheer for a team you prefer are worth checking out, and it reminds us of Epic Seven while also being reminiscent of Arknights. The game, unusually, uses both 3D models and fully narrated story beats. They do make use of this, with the additional motions expressing the situation much more effectively than a flashing screen and modified 2D sprites as in other games of this genre.

The objectives to be protected also change as the tale progresses through the mission phases. The objective's HP has a health metre, unlike Arknights, giving you greater room for error. The placement of units is done on designated hex-



agons, with melee and ranged units having different markings. A radius surrounding a unit represents their area of effect, and talents are often only usable inside this radius even if they have an AOE impact. You can just drag their symbol from the bottom of the screen up if a unit can use it without needing to be targeted.

The basic basics aren't particularly thrilling: deploy units, prevent enemies from reaching the goal, trigger Melantha's skill and cry about not having enough deployment points. Character rarity ranges from N, R, SR, and SSR;

the higher the rarity, the finer the talents and other attributes. But to us it seems excessive to have so many factors in character development, from the equipment gacha to the requirement for several copies for an awakening is just unnecessary complications in our opinion. Although you can still progress quite far even with free, low rarity troops with more effort, we just did not find the story gripping enough to make us continue.

Nova: Iron Galaxy

STONE3's Nova: Iron Galaxy is a casual sci fi strategy title where players are given access to their own space station, which they can defend and upgrade. While guiding you into a game with gorgeous graphics that regrettably never takes the time to explain its game mechanics, the booming voice-over in the opening cinematic underlines the significance of your role in the galaxy. Following a short cinematic, the game introduces you to a group of characters. You can now begin assembling your first fleet. These fleets eliminate extraterrestrial dangers, gather resources for constructing and enhancing ships, and generate the money required to upgrade your space station further. The game also has a storyline that is gradually being revealed. You learn that in the past, a struggle caused you to lose some of your memories. There is a tiny cast of characters, primarily galactic generals and

others of comparable rank to the character. They primarily serve as exposition and have no bearing at all on gameplay. The majority of the game is composed of repeating gameplay cycles where you send your fleet into war, then upgrade with the loot earned. You keep repeating for more loot until you get enough for a specific upgrade. And then do it again once more for another. We did not notice much differences between continuous battles either as we advanced in the game, making it feel more like a repetitive struggle. The player is neither informed of nor displayed the most crucial features that are required for advancement. Even after about 20 stages, only half of the available menu is described;

which is more than enough time for games to cover crucial game mechanics. Hence the world-building and lavish aesthetics are just overshadowed by the monotonous gameplay and mysterious mechanics, which boils down to you just idly watching the same actions play out over and over again.

